

39 Best Nigerian Foods For Weight Loss

Here are the best Nigerian foods for weight-loss

FRUITS

1. Mango



The secret is in the phytochemicals,

which act as natural fat busters and are found only on the outside of the fruit, according to researchers in Australia.

Mango is even sold as a commercial weight loss supplement in the US where they don't have mangos.



2. Berries



Berries AKA 'tiny but mighty'—are full of antioxidants and fibre.

Less I forget, they're low in calories too.

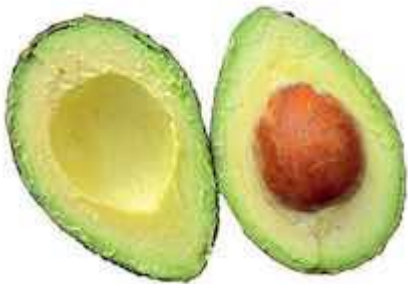
Studies have shown that the antioxidant, anthocyanin, found in berries can **alter gene** activity in **fat cells**, making it harder to gain weight.

So, next time you want something sweet, juicy, and good for you, reach for blueberries, grapes, or strawberries –and don't feel guilty!

You might be asking:

Can I find berries in Nigeria?. Yes! In major supermarkets and farmers markets.

4. **Avocado**



Avocado is a unique type of fruit.

They are rich in nutrients, minerals, fibre, and vitamins.

Avocados are high in monounsaturated fatty acids, which can help to **shrink belly fat**.

Half an avocado mixed with tomatoes makes a great breakfast. You can add avocado to your salad as well.

5. Olive And Olive Oil



“Extra Virgin olive oil” is probably the **healthiest fat** on the planet.

It CAN help you to burn fat.

Olive oil contains a naturally-occurring chemical called oleic acid, which aids the breakdown of excess fats in the body.

Also, the Polyunsaturated fats found in olive oil can **delay hunger**.

The bottom line is:

You should start cooking most of your dishes with Olive oil if you’re trying to lose weight

6. Apples

Apples contain pectin—and ingredient that naturally slows digestion and encourages feelings of fullness.

Studies have shown that eating a whole apple instead of apple juice with your meal is a natural appetite suppressant

which helps you consume fewer overall calories without feeling deprived!

7. Pears

Pears are high in the fibre pectin (natural fruit sugars), which has been shown to help suppress appetite and aid in healthy digestion.

They are also good at eliminating unwanted water retention. So whenever you're craving junk food, reach out for a pear to save you!

8. Bananas

Contrary to the popular belief, bananas contribute to weight loss NOT gain.

Banana provides the body with Zinc (skin healing), filling fibre, potassium, etc.

Banana helps you relieve water retention because of the high potassium content.

Talking about potassium, make sure check out the next food on the list.

9. Watermelon

Just half a melon contains almost twice as much potassium as bananas do, making it a low-calorie, high-antioxidant alternative that can help in the removal of excess fluids around the body.

Watermelon (including seeds) has too many benefits than I can count on all my fingers and toes.

10. Plantain

A half cup of cooked plantains packs almost 3grams of resistant starch, a healthy carb that boosts metabolism and burns fat.

Fry less often please! Make sure you're mostly eating cooked or grilled plantains.

11. Grapefruit

If you want a good body then eating grapefruits is one of the best things to do.

Grapefruit boosts metabolism and makes your body burn extra fat.

There's more:

It's a great source of fiber, which balances your blood glucose level.

If you don't want to overeat, eating half a grapefruit about a half hour before your meals may help you feel full and eat fewer overall calories.

12. Lemons

Lemon is a well-known detoxifier.

It's a great natural weapon against water retention and could help you achieve a flatter stomach.

Adding lemon to water is also great for weight loss (it makes you feel full and it doesn't contain any significant calories).

Lemon juice also contains pectin – a type of soluble fibre that can help slow digestion, which is great for weight loss.

13. Papaya (Pawpaw)

Papaya contains a naturally-occurring enzyme called “papain”, which aids in protein digestion.

It can also help in breaking down food faster, easing bloating and flattening out your belly in no time.

14. Pineapple

Just like pawpaw, pineapple boasts a digestive enzyme that helps to ease bloating, settle down your stomach, and even relieve heartburn.

It’s high in natural fruit sugars or fructose, which could keep off sweet cravings.

15. Oranges

This citrus fruit, which contains fat-blasting compounds known as flavones, deserves to be your main squeeze.

Women who ate the most flavones had a much lower increase in body fat over a 14-year period, a study in The American Journal of Clinical Nutrition notes.

Eat oranges sliced or squeeze fresh OJ (including pulp!) to get the best benefit from the fruit.

VEGETABLES

16. Cucumber

Cucumber is a low-calorie vegetable that's rich in fibre and fills your tummy up quickly.

If you are serious about losing weight then snack on cucumber or add them to your salads.

Finally, they also contain antioxidants such as quercetin and apigenin that helps fight cancer and lowers your risk of heart diseases.

17. Tomatoes

Tomatoes are essential because they not only make your food taste better, they're full of antioxidants AND they help you lose weight.

It has been found to help you lose weight by reducing inflammation and water retention in the body.

Also they help in reversing leptin resistance (Leptin is a type of protein which helps to regulate metabolic rate and appetite, so our bodies rely on it to shed those extra pounds.)

18. Chilli Pepper

Adding chilli pepper to your food can be useful for weight-loss because they contain a substance called capsaicin – which helps reduce appetite and make you burn fat quicker!.

This substance is even sold in supplement form and is a common ingredient in many commercial weight loss supplements.

Also, a single chilli pepper contains a full day's supply of beta-carotene (which is great for maintaining healthy skin, hair and nails)

and twice your recommended daily allowance of vitamin C – an essential antioxidant that battle toxins and foreign bodies in the bloodstream.

19. Okra

Okra is a vegetable high in fibre, which helps to regulate bowel function and encourage the growth of friendly bacteria in the belly.

In addition, it helps stabilize blood sugar levels and lower high cholesterol, reducing the risk of heart diseases.

Try cooking your okra soup with little oil, then you're good to go!

20. Cabbage

Cabbage is high in vitamin C and antioxidants.

Want to know the best part?

Cabbage extremely low in calories (just 22cal per cup), so you can fill your plate with the cabbage and not feel guilty 😊\

21. Broccoli

Broccoli is rich in filling fiber and only contains 30 calories per serving.

Also, it's a great source of calcium and an important cancer-fighting compound.

If eating broccoli causes bloating for you then try steaming it first (not cooking or boiling), which makes it easier to digest while still preserving the cancer-fighting ingredients

And yes you can find broccoli in farmers market and major supermarkets in Nigeria!

22. Carrot

Carrots are not only juicy but are also high in fiber, which fills you up quickly. They also contain Vitamin A & K and they are good for your eyes.

So what I'm saying is...

Try eating carrots as snacks in between meals for better eyes and body.

23. Irish Potatoes

True, potatoes are high in carbs, but potatoes aren't the enemy.

A 2008 study found that potatoes are the food that helped people feel satisfied the most. Plus they're also rich in Resistant Starch, which helps your body burn fat.

Cook them, don't fry.

Replace that white bread breakfast with potatoes because potatoes are three times as filling as a slice of white bread yet healthier.

24. Sweet Potatoes

Sweet potato is one of the best foods on the planet!

They are high in fiber and all sorts of vitamins than I can count on all my fingers and toes.

Despite the name "sweet", they contain Blood-sugar-regulating properties making them a good food for diabetics.

25. Yams

Yams are great weight loss breakfast options because they cook fast.

Most importantly:

They're rich in fibre which feels fill you up quickly and keeps you satisfied for a longer time.

GRAINS AND LEGUMES

26. Oats

Oats are mainly made up of insoluble fibre. This insoluble fibre not only gives you a feeling of satisfaction that keeps you from feeling hungry for a long time but also does not contribute to any calorie addition to the body.

Switch your breakfast cereal for a bowl of oatmeal, and you just may see body fat disappear

27. Ofada Rice

If you can't live without rice, then eat ofada ... a healthier version of white rice because they're complex carbohydrate and rich in protein and vitamins.

It is also better because it contains a rich supply of energizing B vitamins, which could help you burn calories faster.

Beabnns

Nutrients including protein and fibre are packed in each tiny bean.

Want to know the best part?

Beans tend to contain some resistant starch, which stops you from feeling hungry for a long time, while the high protein content will help burn fat and keep your body toned.

Try adding beans to your diet to shift your body into fat-melting mode.

NUTS AND SEEDS

28. Almonds

Almonds are packed with protein and also have high fibre content that stops you feeling hungry. In 2007, researchers at Purdue University also reported that – despite the fact they are relatively high in calories – almonds themselves do not contribute to belly fat.

Want to know the best part?

Almonds packed full of skin-boosting vitamin E

Snack on a handful of almonds in between meals and see a difference in your weight and skin.

29. Coconut And Coconut Oil

Not all fats are created equal.

Coconut oil is high in fatty acids

Studies have shown that these fatty acids not only keep you satisfied for a long time but also increases the number of calories burned.

But you know that....

Coconut oil still contains calories, so the idea is not *drink* coconut oil, but *replacing* some of your other cooking oils with coconut oil.

30. Nuts (Cashew, Peanuts & Walnuts)

Nuts have a bad reputation in the diet world but actually are excellent weight loss snacks.

They containing balanced amounts of protein, fibre, healthy fats, heart-friendly omega-3s, and skin-conditioning vitamin E.

Eat a small handful of nuts as a snack in between meals if you want a flat

stomach and a slim waistline.

A 2011 study found that people who ate an ounce of nuts a day had higher levels of the "feel-good" hormone serotonin, which can act as an appetite suppressant. Higher serotonin levels may also help diminish stress levels — a big help when it comes to the fight against belly fat.

Just make sure not to over eat it, as they are still pretty high in calories – one handful is perfect.

HERBS AND SPICES

31. Garlic

Garlic might not be the best for your breath...

BUT it's definitely the best for a flatter tummy and a good health

because garlic is packed not just with toxin-battling antioxidants, but also a naturally occurring chemical called allicin.

When digested, allicin reacts with the blood to create a product capable of killing off many harmful bacteria and viruses that your body may be harbouring – including in the digestive tract.

To get the most out of garlic try adding a few raw cloves to your food just before serving

32. Ginger

Ginger has anti-inflammatory, anti-nausea and antioxidant properties, which helps to aid digestion. It also contains an enzyme called zingibain, which helps digest proteins.

The bottom line is:

Start using ginger to spice up your food if you're serious about winning the weight-loss battle.

ANIMAL PRODUCE

33. Egg (Plus the Yolk.)

Whole egg (plus yolk) is one of the best foods you can eat if you need to lose weight.

They're high in protein, healthy fats, and can make you feel full with a very low amount of calories.

If you're trying to lose weight it will be a good idea to add eggs to your breakfast.

34. Natural Yoghurt

Yoghurt contains live probiotic bacteria that aid digestion and also helps to relieve bloating and discomfort in the stomach.

Go for unsweetened yoghurt In between meals to help protect against

35. Turkey

Turkey is a great source of lean protein.

And we already know that protein in your diet is important when you're trying to achieve a balanced weightless, since protein helps to preserve muscle mass and keeps you feeling full.

Pound for pound turkey has lower calories and fat than chicken breast(which is also great for a balanced weight loss)

36. Seafoods

Seafoods (E.G. Crabs,Crayfish E.T.C)

Seafoods are jam-packed with all kinds of fat-burning properties, such as calcium and protein.

Add seafoods to your diet because they are the perfect weapon against excess fat.

37. Mackerel (AKA Titus)

Eating a lot of oily fish like mackerel is a good idea if you want to lose weight and belly fat because it's high in protein and low in 'bad' or saturated fats.

It gets better:

These bad boys are not only tasty but are excellent sources of omega-3 fatty and omega-6 fatty acids, which are important for proper brain function

Slimmer AND smarter! – sounds great to me

38. Apple Cider Vinegar

Vinegar especially Apple cider vinegar is added to a lot of healthy food recipe because they are rich in vitamins and studies have shown that they can lower the glycemic index of high-carb foods like pasta.

Adding vinegar to your meals (like salad) amongst many other benefits can keep you from feeling hungry.

39. Dark Chocolate

Studies show that Dark chocolates are high in healthy fats (MUFAs), which can help kick start your metabolism to burn fat. It may also help by reducing your cravings for sweet, salty or fatty meals